KARIM ELSARHA

Procurement & Inventory Planning Manager
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Nationality: Egyptian | Available to join within one month | Open to relocation (KSA/GCC)

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Procurement & Inventory Planning Manager with 18+ years of experience, currently at the Suez Canal Economic Zone (SCZONE). Manages procurement and Distribution Requirements Planning (DRP) for everything from office supplies to large-scale port infrastructure across major national projects. Delivered up to 35% savings in procurement costs through supplier negotiation. Introduced AI-assisted demand forecasting that raised order fulfillment accuracy to 98% and cut excess inventory by 55%. Experienced in FIDIC/USAID compliance, SAP MM, and supplier performance management.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Suez Canal Economic Zone (SCZONE), *Cairo, Egypt*
Procurement & Inventory Planning Manager | *Jan 2025 – Present*

- Keeps procurement and inventory operations compliant with FIDIC conditions, legal frameworks, and governance requirements.
- Manages high-value contracts end-to-end, including regulatory risk and contract disputes.
- Automated RFQ/RFP workflows in SAP MM, cutting bid cycle time by 60% and reducing manual processing errors by 80%.
- Led the SAP MM implementation, covering knowledge transfer, staff training, documentation, and SCZONE's representation in project meetings.
- Leads supplier negotiations on payment terms and pricing, reducing procurement costs by up to 35% without disrupting supply continuity.
- Works closely with legal and finance teams to clear contract approvals faster, cutting delays by 80%.
- Improved supplier on-time delivery by 65% through a performance scorecard linked to contract renewals and continuous improvement programs.
- Runs Distribution Requirements Planning (DRP) across multiple sites using Min-Max levels, ABC classification, and demand forecasting to balance stock availability and holding costs.
- Deployed AI-assisted demand forecasting and real-time inventory tracking that cut excess inventory by 55% and raised order fulfillment accuracy to 98%.
- Built a web application (Python, Flask, SQLite) to replace the manual Excel and Power Query workflow for tracking employee custody items (issue, return, addition).
- Feeds inventory and demand data into S&OP discussions.
- Authored the Warehouse Regulation (13 chapters plus appendices, based on Egyptian government references and international standards, including ISO 55000 and CIPS) and the Procurement & Contracts Regulations.
- Leads, coaches, and develops a team of 25 professionals.

Procurement & Inventory Control Section Head | *May 2016 – Jan 2025*

- Managed the full procurement cycle, including RFQ, ITB, and RFP processes, and monitored bid compliance throughout the bid lifecycle.
- Evaluated supplier quotes and proposals on price, delivery terms, and service offerings.
- Onboarded 800+ suppliers through an evaluation system and disqualified 19% of them for underperformance.
- Conducted market research to identify sourcing opportunities, benchmark pricing, and align bid strategies with current market conditions.
- Oversaw day-to-day warehouse operations: inventory control, stock management, and distribution workflows.
- Introduced barcode tracking for warehouse operations, which improved inventory accuracy.

Red Sea Ports Authority (RSPA), *Suez, Egypt*
Budgeting & Cost Accountant | *Jun 2008 – May 2016*

- Collected, analyzed, and reported on operational cost data to support management decision-making and cost control initiatives.
- Assessed the financial impact of changes in goods and services on overall operational costs.
- Helped prepare and consolidate RSPA's annual budget and multi-year financial forecasts.

- Monitored budget performance through the fiscal year, identified variances, and recommended corrective actions.
- Collaborated with department heads to gather budget inputs and align them with organizational strategy.

KEY SKILLS

Procurement & Contracting: Government Procurement, Strategic Sourcing, Tendering (RFQ/ITB/RFP), Contract Management, Supplier Negotiation, FIDIC/USAID Compliance, Letters of Credit, P2P (Procure-to-Pay), Category Management, Total Cost of Ownership (TCO), Green Procurement.

Inventory & Supply Chain: Distribution Requirements Planning (DRP), Inventory Planning & Optimization, Min-Max Strategy, ABC Analysis, Demand Forecasting, Reorder Point Optimization, Lead-Time Modeling, AI-assisted Forecasting, S&OP Support.

Systems & Technology: SAP MM, Power BI, Advanced Excel, Barcode & Real-Time Tracking Systems, ERP Systems.

Leadership & Collaboration: Team Management (25 professionals), Cross-functional Stakeholder Collaboration, Supplier Performance Management.

Languages: Arabic (Native) | English (Professional).

PROJECTS PORTFOLIO

General Procurement Projects

Managed end-to-end procurement for high-value categories, including vehicles, IT equipment, office furniture, and critical spare parts.

Infrastructure Upgrade Projects

Led procurement and coordination for major infrastructure works, including the Ain Sokhna Port VTS navigation tower (in partnership with the Suez Canal Authority, under a below-market contract, delivered in 7 to 8 months), the Adabiya Port development, and the installation of a complete sewage station system.

Security & Safety Systems Projects

Oversaw sourcing and implementation of safety systems, including fire suppression networks, explosive detection devices, and investor communication systems.

International Import Projects

Executed international procurement for critical port systems: navigational devices (Vissim, Norway), marine spare parts (Mapso, Switzerland), and a natural gas station unit (Pietro Fiorentini, Italy), including regulatory compliance and customs clearance.

Consultancy & Technical Studies Projects

Collaborated with global consultants on environmental studies for Ain Sokhna Port and supervised procurement for the Port Said Quays development program.

EDUCATION

Master's Degree in Supply Chain Management | Arab Academy for Science, Technology & Maritime Transport (AASTMT), Egypt | In Progress

Relevant coursework: Six Sigma.

Bachelor's Degree in Commerce (Accounting) | Suez University, Egypt

Associate Degree in Management Information Systems | Suez Higher Institute for Management Information Systems, Egypt

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Project Management Professional (PMP) *· PMI · In Progress*
- LinkedIn Learning (course completions): Become a Supply Chain Manager, Negotiation Skills, Project Management Foundations (Procurement), Inventory Management Foundations.

TRAINING & LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT

Industrial Transformation & Economic Development Seminar

Academy for International Business Officials (AIBO) / China Ministry of Commerce (MOFCOM), Beijing, China | Jul–Aug 2024. Participated as part of the official Egyptian delegation under China's Global Development Initiative at the New Industrialization Conference.

Behavioral Barriers | National Center for Training and Leadership (NCTL), Egypt | 2022

Anti-Corruption Training | National Anti-Corruption Academy, Egypt | 2022